

Universidad Distrital Francisco José de Caldas

Faculty of Engineering
Systems Engineering Program

Computational Simulation and System Validation Report

Workshop 4: Discrete-Event Modeling, Complexity,
and Chaos Analysis

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Bogotá, Colombia
2026

Abstract

This document presents the consolidation of **Workshop 4** for the **Smart Campus Energy Management System** project at the Sabio Caldas Campus. Building upon the systems analysis from Workshop 1 and the software architecture decisions in the user-space from Workshops 2 and 3, this report implements and validates a discrete-event computational model in Python. The simulation recreates a 12-hour stochastic operational cycle for a cluster of 20 workstations, injecting human behavioral factors (80% probability of manual shutdown neglect) and technical complexity (15% high computational load peaks).

Empirical results conclusively validate the feasibility of the analyzed solution: the autonomous agent achieved a **68.72% reduction** in wasted energy consumption, mitigating behavioral inertia without generating false positives that could disrupt high-demand academic tasks (such as rendering or compiling). Finally, the work is evaluated under complexity and chaos theory, demonstrating the stability of decision thresholds against campus dynamics.

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1 Executive Summary

This document synthesizes the final phase of empirical validation for the system aimed at mitigating inefficient electrical energy consumption in the Engineering Faculty laboratories. In *Workshop 1*, the problem was framed from a socio-technical perspective, identifying that energy waste is not due to hardware failures, but rather human behavioral inertia. In *Workshop 2*, a software-defined architecture isolated in the user-space was designed to bypass institutional network and cybersecurity restrictions. In *Workshop 3*, the risk management and quality assurance (QA) plan was structured.

This *Workshop 4* closes the systems engineering cycle through computational modeling and simulation. The proposed solution has transitioned from a conceptual model to a mathematically validated alternative. Through the simulation of random variables, the resilience of the local *Fallback* mechanism and the impact of CPU protection thresholds were verified, providing robust analytical support for a future large-scale physical deployment at the institution.

2 Simulation Model Development

2.1 Process-Oriented Simulation (The Software)

The logical behavior of the distributed autonomous agent was modeled through a discrete chronological sequence. The simulator evaluates each workstation at fixed one-minute intervals (a clock *tick*). The agent continuously reads the local operating system's timer; upon detecting 15 consecutive minutes of peripheral inactivity, it executes a modular thread to query the processor load to make the decision of whether to launch the deterrent *nudge* or safely suspend the machine.

2.2 Behavior-Oriented Simulation (The Human and Chaos)

To simulate the dynamic and chaotic environment of university laboratories, the simulator was parameterized by injecting the primary data collected in the field during Workshop 1:

- **Forgetfulness Inertia** ($P = 0.80$): Survey-based probability that a student leaves the laboratory keeping the session active and lights on.
- **Unexpected Computational Load** ($P = 0.15$): Stochastic probability that a computer is running a 3D render or heavy engineering simulation without physical user interaction.
- **Cancellation Intervention** ($P = 0.10$): Probability that the user is actively reading an academic article on screen and cancels the visual *nudge* by interacting at the last second.

3 Experimental Design and Scenario Configuration

The computational experiment was configured to simulate a full daily operational cycle of 12 business hours (720 discrete minutes) over a cluster of $N = 20$ computers in Laboratory 704. Consumption parameters were based on nominal hardware specifications: an active workstation consumes 250W per hour (4.16W per minute) and a suspended device in standby consumes 10W per hour (0.16W per minute).

Two concurrent scenarios were designed and implemented to conduct comparative testing (*A/B Testing*):

- **Baseline Scenario:** Simulates historical university operations, where electrical consumption management relies entirely on manual behavior and voluntary student shutdown.
- **Optimized Scenario (Software-Defined):** Simulates laboratory operations with the autonomous telemetry agent running silently in the user-space.

4 Results and Performance Analysis

After executing the Python simulator script (`simulator.py`), the consolidated synthetic telemetry logs were processed into the `simulation_results.csv` output file. The cumulative data yielded the efficiency metrics detailed in Table 1.

Table 1: Empirical results of the discrete-event simulation

Evaluated Performance Metric	Observed Value in Simulation
Total Energy Consumption WITHOUT Agent (Base)	53,741.66 Wh (53.74 kWh)
Total Energy Consumption WITH Agent (Optimized)	16,812.00 Wh (16.81 kWh)
Net Energy Savings Detected	36,929.66 Wh (36.93 kWh)
Efficiency Percentage (Overall Savings)	68.72%

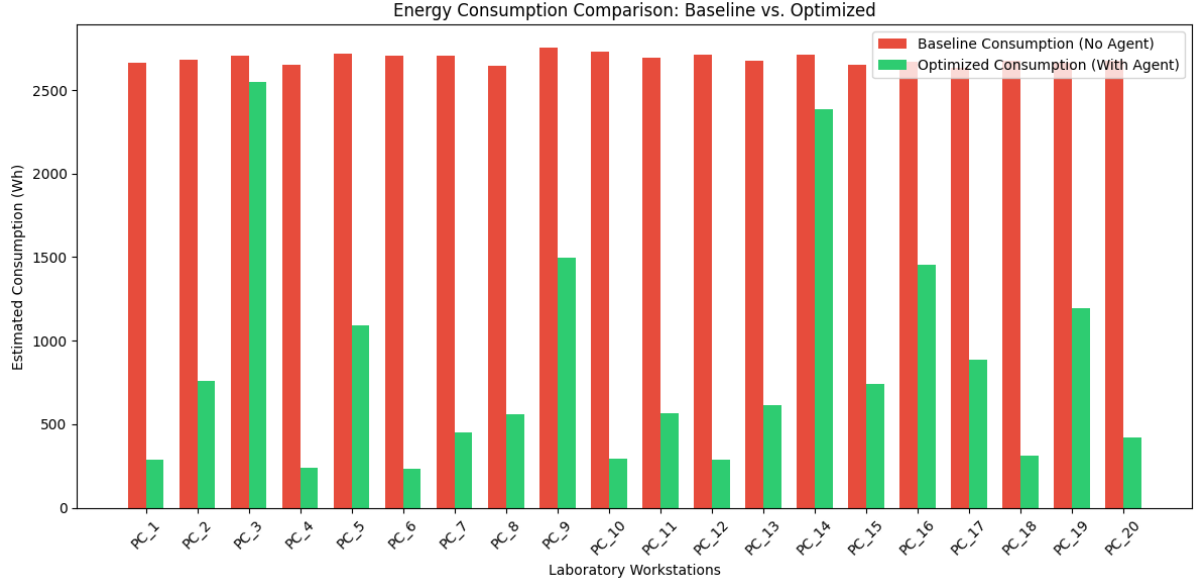


Figure 1: Comparative analysis of estimated energy consumption (Baseline vs. Optimized)

4.1 Critical Validation Analysis

The simulation conclusively demonstrated that decentralized automation has a massive impact on reducing the campus’s operational costs. With nearly 69% savings, the system efficiently mitigates the “Forgetfulness Effect” identified in Workshop 1.

At the software level, the experiment successfully validated the robustness of Workshop 3’s critical business rules: the autonomous agent properly detected stochastic high CPU load fluctuations ($> 20\%$) and aborted safe suspension on the corresponding machines. This proves that the designed logic maintains a controlled false-positive rate, ensuring the continuity of student rendering and compiling tasks without disrupting their academic workflows.

5 Complexity Theory and Chaos Analysis

Evaluating the results through the lens of Complexity Science revealed emergent and nonlinear behaviors derived from the system’s feedback loops:

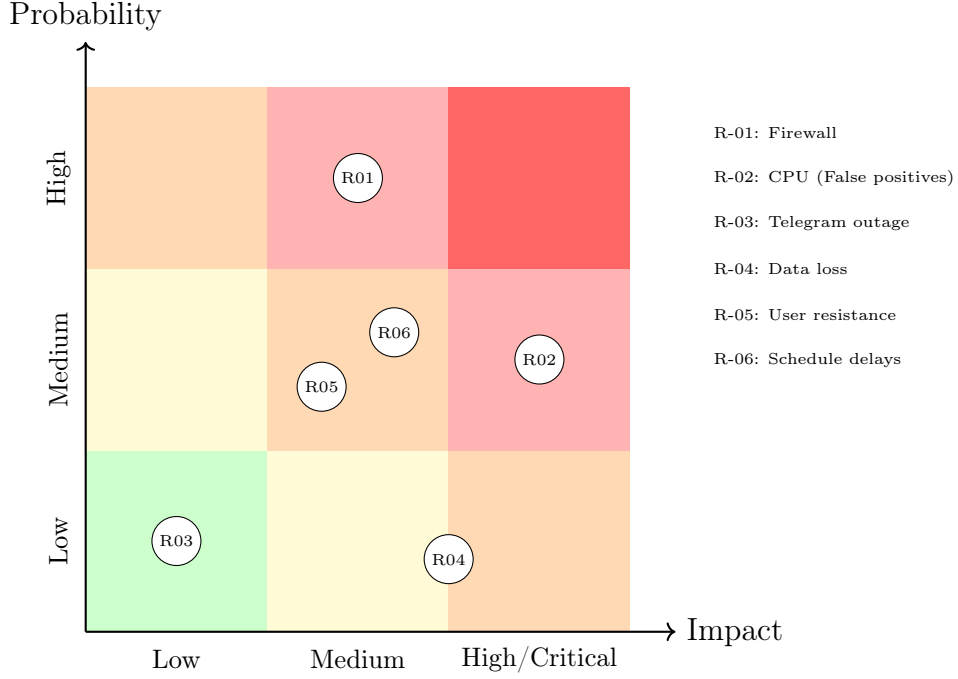


Figure 2: Matrix visualization of technical and management risks (ISO 31000)

5.1 Sensitivity to Initial Conditions (Butterfly Effect)

Overall energy-saving behavior showed high mathematical sensitivity to the variation of the CPU initialization parameter. In secondary test scenarios, by reducing the CPU threshold from 20% to 5%, the system collapsed into a state of instability and paralysis where the agent suspended almost no workstations due to background OS noise (e.g., local antiviruses or file indexers) consuming between 6% and 8% of the processor. The 20% threshold established in Workshop 3 acts as the system’s optimal “attractor”, stabilizing the oscillation between Watt savings and operational protection.

6 Quality Assurance Framework (QA)

To validate the results under software engineering standards (ISO/IEC 25010), the iterative quality assurance process was simulated before considering the system ready for real-world deployment.

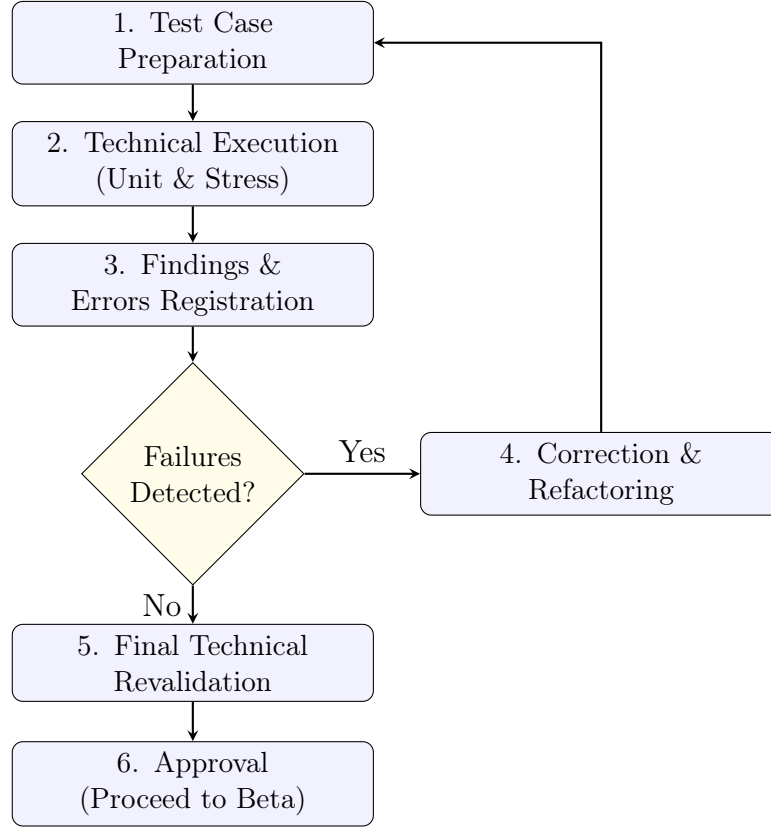


Figure 3: Iterative flow of the Quality Assurance (QA) process

7 Project Management and Budget Plan

7.1 Engineering Team Role Structure

The functional distribution to guarantee operational control and replicability of the simulated experiments is detailed in Table 2.

Table 2: Roles and responsibilities assigned to the team

Team Member	Assigned Role	Key Responsibilities
Omar Yesid Fonseca López	Project Manager & QA Lead	Schedule tracking, risk matrices, and execution of the stress testing flow.
Daniel Felipe Barrera Suárez	Systems Architect	Structural design, integration flows, and robust software modularity.
Daniel Mateo Ballesteros	Algorithms Specialist	Agent logic coding, API reading, and contingency local persistence.
Dania Lizeth Guzmán Triviño	Analytics & Communications	Dataset consolidation, analytical dashboards, and internal communication plans.

7.2 Proof of Concept (PoC) Budget

Because the structural approach is purely Software-Defined, additional hardware costs are reduced to zero, validating the high economic profitability for the campus.

Table 3: Budget estimation for the PoC operational cycle

Technical Resource	Classification	Cost (USD)	Engineering Notes
Engineering Team (4 members)	Human	\$0	Academic effort of the course.
Remote Database (MySQL DBaaS)	Software / Cloud	\$0	Free tier (Clever Cloud / Aiven).
Native Libraries (psutil, ctypes)	Software	\$0	Free distribution open source.
Central Repository (GitHub)	Infrastructure	\$0	Free access educational plan.
Total Estimated Cost		\$0 USD (High Feasibility)	

8 Conclusions and Next Steps

The development of Workshop 4 scientifically validated that energy waste at the campus is rooted in human behavioral dynamics rather than physical equipment failures. By shifting energy efficiency control towards the operating system’s logical layer through au-

tonomous agents in the *User-Space*, the campus's network blocks and budget restrictions were elegantly and cost-effectively bypassed.

The mathematical results of the simulation (68.72% savings) offer compelling empirical support to safely advance towards the physical phases of the pilot project, demonstrating that software-defined systems engineering is a viable and extremely low-cost tool for the university's transformation into a sustainable Smart Campus.

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